

Ash-Waxed Letter Concerning Lucan Hollowmere and Thessaly Coldwater

To the hand that still reads,

I send this beneath a plain seal, for the Silent Choir teaches that a sealed word is less dangerous than a spoken one. Whether that teaching is wisdom or merely the Choir's preferred arrangement of silence, I cannot say. I know only what has been preserved, and what has been preserved may already have been trimmed.

The Silent Choir is a secretive priesthood that records, censors, and rewrites history. Its religious authority is exercised through control of the historical record. The Choir's appearance is priestly and restrained, defined by secrecy and the keeping of records. Its demeanor is quiet, inscrutable, and deliberate in its handling of truth. Thus, when a page bears their mark, one must ask not only what is written, but what was refused entry.

Of Lucan Hollowmere, the surviving account is narrow. Lucan Hollowmere is a minor figure of the Ashen Era, born in 296 AS. He serves as an herbalist. No canonical physical details are recorded; his visual identity is associated only with the work of an herbalist. His canonical temperament is unrecorded. I have found no lawful line naming his loyalties, his fears, or the shape of his conscience. If such lines once existed, they are beyond my reach—or beyond the Choir's permission.

Thessaly Coldwater is likewise a minor figure of the Ashen Era, born in 338 AS. Thessaly serves as an Outrider. No canonical physical features are established for Thessaly Coldwater; their visual identity is limited to their role as an Outrider. No canonical temperament is established for Thessaly Coldwater. These absences should not be mistaken for proof of meekness, treachery, courage, or any other convenient virtue. A blank is not a confession. I have seen too many blanks dressed as verdicts.

I place these facts before you without ornament, though the Silent Choir would call even this arrangement an interpretation. Perhaps they are right. A record is a kind of road, and every road leaves some ground untouched.

Guard this letter from any hand that prefers a clean history. Burn it if necessary. If you do, remember that the ashes will tell no one whether the words were true.

In caution and imperfect faith, **A Keeper of Unquiet Records**